

BAPTISMS

Description of Baptism Discussions

At camp, students will have an opportunity to be baptized during the baptism service on the fourth night of camp. Starting day one of camp, after the evening service, leaders can begin communicating with their groups about baptism, encouraging them to weigh the decision.

At camp, students will express directly to their group leader if they would like to get baptized. The group leader will walk the students through a series of questions found in the "How" section below.

After having the discussion about baptism, if the leader discerns the student should be baptized, they will go with the student to the main office. In the main office, they will confirm that the student has parental consent to be baptized. If they have parental consent, the student will be added to the baptism list by the main office.

Immediately following this, the leader will contact the student's parents and invite them to the baptism service. In this communication, the leader will inform the parent of their needed arrival time, the baptism service time, answer any questions the parents may have, and send the parent the visitor registration link below.

<https://cofchurches.com/cc-visitor>

Goal of Baptisms Discussions

Ensure students have an understanding of what baptism means.

Ensure students have accepted Jesus as their Lord and Savior before being baptized, as baptism is a physical response to a spiritual transformation.

Ensure students are not being baptized out of habit.

Ensure students are not being baptized out of pressure or fear.

How to Have Baptisms Discussions

"Gather the Gospel." Ask students, **"Who is Jesus is to you?"** Listen for an understanding of the Gospel - human sin and the atonement found in Jesus. Not atonement found works.

"Wonder Why." Ask students, **"Why do you want to be baptized?"** Listen for an expression of wanting to make their faith public, and wanting to walk in obedience. Listen for students that think baptism = salvation, and gently express that is not the case. Listen for students that want to be baptized because it's what they always do at camp, and gently express that is not the purpose of baptism.

"Repeat Renewal." It is not uncommon for a student to want to be baptized when they have already been baptized before. Ask students, **"Have you been baptized before?"** It is okay if they have, but their desire to be baptized again must be for the right reason. Listen for students who express that they'd been baptized in the past, but walked away from God, or fell back into the patterns of their old life without repentance. Re-affirmation or rededication is welcomed, as long as they hold an understanding of what they're communicating by being baptized.